



PAPUA NEW GUINEA

A GATHERING OF TRIBES



EACH YEAR OVER 50 DIFFERENT cultural groups from all over Papua New Guinea gather together in the West Highlands province for the spectacular and flamboyant Mount Hagen Cultural Show. It was originally started as a way to calm tribal animosities and to celebrate the enormous diversity of traditional ways. All the groups dress up in their most colorful displays of makeup and ornamentation to impress the other clans. The whole show is such a visual extravaganza that it has become a huge tourist attraction. Up to 50,000 people have been known to descend on the area. The Asaro clan in this picture are famous for their extraordinary mud masks and mud body paint.